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Employment

Postdoctoral Researcher, Department of Economics, Purdue University — 2025 - current

Education

Ph.D., M.S., Economics, Purdue University — West Lafayette, IN, USA, 2025
M.A., Economics, Sun Yat-sen University — Guangzhou, China, 2019
B.A., Public Finance, Wuhan University — Wuhan, China, 2017

Research Interests

Urban/Spatial Economics, International Trade, Applied Microeconomics, Corporate Finance, Environmental Economics

Research

Working Papers

The Productivity Externality of Working from Home: Welfare and Policy Implications (PDF)(Abstract)

- Selected Presentations: UEA (2026), SMUE (2026), CES (2026), Remote Work Conference (2025), MEA (2025)

How Globalization Changes the Level and Structure of Executive Compensation with David Hummels and Jakob R. Munch (PDF)(CEPR VoxEU)(Abstract)

- Presentations: CFRC (2026), Waseda University (2026), Midwest Trade and Theory (2025)

Work in Progress

Why Are Coaches Paid More Than Presidents? A View from Executive Compensation Theory with David Hummels and Zachary Knepper

- Assignment model with tournament prizes and unobservable coaching ability.
- Test model predictions using data on salaries, turnover, college expenditures, and prediction markets.

Optimal Subsidy for Electric Vehicle in California with Weihua Zhao

- Quantitative spatial model with regional mobility and gas vs. EV car choice driven by transport costs.
- Policy counterfactual analysis on the effect of subsidies for EV purchases and for charging networks.

Presentations

2027: American Economic Association (AEA) Annual Meeting (Poster Section, scheduled)

2026: Summer Meeting in Urban Economics (SMUE), Chinese Economists Society Annual Conference (CES), Annual China Financial Research Conference (CFRC), European Meeting of the Urban

Economics Association (UEA), Waseda University WINPEC Seminars,

2025: Midwest International Trade & Theory Conference, Remote Work Conference, Annual Meetings of the Midwest Economics Association (MEA)

2024: National Association for Business Economics (NABE) Tech Economics Conference

2023: Business Doctoral Student Association Research Symposium

Honors and Awards

Daniels School of Business Doctoral Research Funds, Purdue University	2024
Business Doctoral Student Association Research Symposium Award, Purdue University	2023
Krannert Certificate for Outstanding Teaching, Purdue University	Summer 2021
Outstanding Master's Thesis, Sun Yat-sen University	2019
First Prize Scholarship for Graduate Students, Sun-Yat-sen University	2017
Outstanding Student Scholarship, Wuhan University	2013-2014, 2014-2015
Outstanding Freshman Scholarship, Wuhan University	2013

Teaching Experience

Purdue University

Instructor

Online Instructor: Principles of Economics	Summer 2022, Summer 2021
• Krannert Certificate for Outstanding Teaching	
Recitation Instructor: Principles of Economics	Fall 2019

Teaching Assistant

Intermediate Economics (Masters)	Spring 2022, Fall 2021
Mathematical Analysis for Economists (PhD)	Fall 2021
Econometrics (Undergraduate)	Spring 2021, Fall 2020
Microeconomics (Undergraduate)	Spring 2021
Game Theory (Undergraduate)	Spring 2021
Investment (Masters, Online)	Fall 2020
Principles of Economics (Undergraduate)	Spring 2020, Fall 2020
Macroeconomics (Undergraduate)	Fall 2019
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (Undergraduate)	Fall 2019

Teaching Training and Professional Development

PhD Communication Skills

Service

Conference discussant: 2026 European Meeting of the Urban Economics Association (UEA), 2025 Empirical Investigations in International Trade (EIIT), 2025 Annual Meetings of the Midwest Economics Association (MEA)

Conference session chair: 2026 Chinese Economists Society Annual Conference (CES)

2023 Purdue Trade-Spatial Student Reading Group

2022 Business Doctoral Student Association Peer Mentoring Program

Skills

Structural Model, Causal Inference, Machine Learning, Stata, Matlab, Python, R, SQL

Languages

Chinese, English

References

Chong Xiang (Co-Chair)
Professor of Economics
Purdue University
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Farid Farrokhi (Co-Chair)
Associate Professor of Economics
Boston College
farid.farrokhi@bc.edu

David Hummels
Professor of Economics
Purdue University
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Victoria Prowse
Professor of Economics
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Abstract

The Productivity Externality of Working from Home: Welfare and Policy Implications

I study the socially optimal mix of onsite work and remote work. I develop a model in which workers choose how much to work onsite versus from home, without internalizing the productivity spillovers that occur within and across onsite and remote workers. I measure these spillovers using post-pandemic U.S. survey data at the city-sector-work mode level. Matching the model to these data, I find that a social planner could, on average, improve social welfare by encouraging more onsite workers but encouraging hybrid workers to spend more time working from home. Remote productivity spillovers lower the cost of achieving the social optimum.

How Globalization Changes the Level and Structure of Executive Compensation

with David Hummels, and Jakob R. Munch

We build a model of CEO compensation that unites principal-agent and assignment models in the face of trade shocks that interact with CEO effort. The model predicts that trade shocks change CEO compensation through scale, volatility, and ability-magnification channels. Using Danish matched worker-firm data, we find empirical support for these channels: (1) Exogenous shocks to trade increase the size and value of the firm and CEO compensation; (2) the share of firm value paid to the CEO is increasing in the size and value of the firm and increasing in the volatility induced by global shocks; (3) Higher-ability CEOs generate increases in firm value that are more than 100 times greater than their compensation, through a combination of mitigating losses and maximizing the return to positive shocks.